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GAME COMPONENTS

- 1 game board with stock market and income track
- Rules booklet
- 204 track tiles
- 40 train cards and 6 phase change reminder cards
- 12 Company charters
- 108 Share Certificates
- 9 private railway certificates and 17 associated cardboard reminder markers
- 1 Initial Offering mat
- 1 Open Market mat
- 10 Company status cards (4 “No Director”, 6 “Insolvent”)
- 6 Player Order and 5 Pass Order cards
- 87 wooden tokens for company tokens, private railway bonuses, Game Round, and double-sided “5/10 Share” company status
- 1 “Stephenson’s Rocket” wooden train marker
- 30 cardboard bidding markers (six sets labelled A through F).
- Players must provide a bank of approximately £12,000 for lower player count games and up to £20,000 for higher player count games (poker chips are recommended)
- 12 optional character cards and 23 associated cardboard reminder markers.

1. INTRODUCTION

Cross-references within the rules are denoted by square brackets – [2.2] refers the reader to section 2.2 for additional information about the topic under discussion.

The two to six players in *18GB – The Railways of Great Britain* represent major investors in railway companies during the period 1825-1923. They invest their initial capital in these companies, which then build railway networks and run trains to gain income for their shareholders. The value of shares will rise and fall in relation to the fortunes of the companies. The winner will be the player with the highest total of money and stock value at the end of the game.

1.1 SETTING UP

The game uses different numbers of companies, private railways, and trains depending on how many people are playing. See the back cover of this rulebook for the recommended setup for each player count. (Some player counts have multiple options.) The number of players also determines the amount of money players start with and the certificate limit for each player. Also, grey tiles are only used when five or six people are playing.

When playing with two players, some parts of the map are not in play, and the two red tiles are placed on the map to mark off-board areas, as explained on the back cover. There are two options: the North-South (N-S) configuration and the East-West (E-W) configuration.

1. Lay out the map, the Initial Offering, and the Open Market. Place one station token of each company in the game in their respective Home cities. Put the Director’s Certificate of the LNWR in the marked space on the Initial Offering. Randomly select half of the remaining companies in the game (rounded down) and put their Director’s Certificates in the first tier of the Initial Offering, and the other Director’s Certificates in the second tier. Stack the three Preferred Share Certificates for each company below the Director’s Certificate. Keep the five Ordinary Share Certificates aside for later.

2. Place the appropriate number of 2^{+1} train cards in the Available Trains box and put the Stephenson's Rocket marker on top. Stack the appropriate number of the remaining train types in order, with the 3^{+1} trains at the top and the 6X trains at the bottom. Place the appropriate reminder card below the first train of each type, and place the whole stack in the Future Trains box.
3. Place the "No Director" and "Insolvent" status cards, and the "5/10 Share" status tokens, in the appropriate spaces on the Initial Offering.
4. Put the yellow, green, blue, and brown tiles near the map. Add the grey tiles for games with five or six players. Players also need room near the board for their Share Certificates, two or three company charters, and their personal cash. Set aside the charter and tokens for each company until it enters play.
5. Lay out the bank of poker chips or paper money. Give each player the appropriate starting money for the number of players. There is no limit on the size of the bank. About £12,000 is needed for a three-player game and as much as £20,000 for a five-player game.
6. Take the Player Order cards numbered from 1 to the number of players, and the Pass Order cards from "First Pass" to one fewer than the number of players. Stack the pass cards, in order, near the board. Randomly deal a Player Order card to each player to determine the initial order of play. (The order of play may change during the game, and is always determined by these cards rather than seating position.) Put the Game Round token on the Game Round track.
7. Put the certificates for the private railways in play somewhere players can see and bid on them. For each one, place the corresponding ability markers in the appropriate hexes on the map. (For example, place the "GN reserved" marker in the York hex (I14).) Optionally, place the reminder marker for each one in the hex where the private railway is located, to show that this private railway is in play.

1.2 OVERVIEW OF PLAY

After initial setup [1.3], private railways are auctioned [2.1] and the Player Order for the first Stock Round is set [2.2].

During a Stock Round [5], players take turns to buy and sell shares in companies. The largest shareholder in each company becomes Director of that company [5.3] and will be responsible for making all decisions on behalf of that company. A Stock Round continues until all players pass in succession.

Every Stock Round is followed by two Operating Rounds [6], after which play continues with the next Stock Round. During an Operating Round, each company that has started takes one turn. Its Director lays track tiles and/or station tokens [6.3], raises income by running trains [6.4], and either retains that income in the company or distributes it to the shareholders as dividends [6.5]. Paying dividends or not may change a company's Share Price [6.5.1]. As the last action in its turn, a company may buy new trains [6.6].

The changes that occurred on the railways during this period are reflected by the five Phases of the game [4], denoted by the colours yellow, green, blue, brown, and grey. The current Phase determines aspects of the game such as the track tiles that can be laid and how many trains a company may own [7.2]. The change from one Phase to the next does not affect the order of turns and rounds, which continue as normal.

This gradual improvement of technology is triggered in the game by the availability of new types of trains. When a new type of train enters play, older types may be removed from play [7.1] and a new Phase may be triggered. The game finishes at the end of the Operating Round in which any company's Share Price reaches the top or when there are no more trains to purchase [8].

Throughout the game, all assets and transactions are public knowledge. Players may not transfer money, shares, or any other holdings directly from player to player. All share trading is with the Initial Offering or Open Market. Similarly, the only transactions permitted between companies are when one company buys a train from another.

1.3 DESCRIPTION OF COMPONENTS

1.3.1 THE MAP AND TILES

The map consists of a grid of hexes, on which the track tiles are laid during the game. Co-ordinates are printed on the map for reference purposes.

The grey and red hexes on the map (which may include light blue areas of sea) denote non-buildable areas on which tiles may never be laid. In these non-buildable hexes and around the edges of the map there is some permanent track that may connect to tiles in adjacent hexes. The thick green-coloured hexsides represent hills which restrict track building. The two dark blue hexes are major estuaries and can only be upgraded by specific blue tiles representing the Severn Tunnel (marked "S") and the Forth and Tay Bridges (marked "FT").

Solid black dots or black bars in some hexes and tiles represent towns. Large circles represent the station or stations in a city. Some cities have one station and some have two. Black arrowheads in red hexes denote connections to London (G26), Hull/Grimsby (J17), and towns or cities beyond the edge of the map. The numbers in small circles on town and city tiles indicate the income yielded by those tiles. Hexes and tiles with two stations are labelled "OO" or "XX".

The Home city of each company is indicated by a station containing that company's shield. Some Home cities have a green background: this indicates that the company may place a green tile in its Home city as its first tile action, instead of the usual yellow tile (even before green tiles are normally available).

1.3.2 THE COMPANIES

The companies in the game are some of the major railway companies of the period. Each company is represented by a charter, a Director's Certificate showing 40%/20%, three Preferred Share Certificates showing 20%/10%, five Ordinary Share Certificates showing 10%, and a set of tokens. The company charter is a mat

on which the company's assets (including train cards and station tokens) will be placed.

The Initial Offering area holds unsold Director's Certificates and Preferred Shares. The Open Market area holds Share Certificates that players sell during the game and the extra shares that become available when a five-share company converts to a ten-share company. The 5-share/10-share tokens are used to show how many shares each company has.

The Stock Market will show the current Share Price of each company's shares, using one of the company's tokens. The numbers on the chart show the value of a single share. The Income Track can be used to record company income, using an extra token for each company.

Each company has three or four station tokens that, when placed on the map, give the company access to run trains through particular stations. Each company starts the game with one token in their Home city, and most start the game with one more token available to be placed [10].

Private railways represent small railway companies that either preceded or operated alongside the larger public companies. They are each represented by a certificate. Each private railway also has a corresponding hex on the map, which is indicated by a linked pair of small circles and the abbreviation of the private railway's name. The reverse side of each private railway certificate describes that private railway's special ability.

1.3.3 THE TRAINS

The train cards represent the rolling stock available to the companies. Each card shows the type of the train, its price, and when it will be removed from play.

The Available Trains box holds the train cards of the currently available type that have yet to be purchased. The Future Trains box holds train cards of types that are not yet available. When the last card is taken from the Available Trains box, replenish the box with the next type of train.

When the first 4X is taken from the Available Trains box, move the 5X train cards into the Available Trains box alongside the remaining 4X train cards. When the first 5X is taken, do the same with the 6X cards. Thus several types of X train may be available for purchase at the same time.

1.3.4 OTHER COMPONENTS

Use the Game Round token to keep track of the current round on the Game Round track as the game progresses.

The status cards are used to indicate certain statuses that may apply to companies during the game. A company has no director whenever its Director's Certificate is in the Open Market. A company may be Insolvent if it does not own a train. Either of these statuses may be removed when the company status ends. The number of cards provided should be sufficient; if more are required, players may improvise additional cards.

2. PRIVATE RAILWAYS

After setting up the game, the first step is to distribute the private railway certificates using the auction rules below.

2.1 PRIVATE RAILWAY AUCTION

Each player takes a set of bidding markers. Players take turns in Player Order, in which they may bid on any of the items on offer. If a player has the existing (high) bid on one or more items, or if there are no items without a bid at all, they may pass instead of making an additional bid. (In two-player games, a player must have the winning bid on two or more items.) If the player passes, they may still make another bid in a later turn in the auction.

Bids are indicated by placing one or more bidding markers on the item. The first marker indicates a bid equal to the face value and each subsequent marker raises the bid by £5. For each player, the total of their current bids may never exceed their money. If one player is outbid by another, their bid on that item lapses and they take back their bidding markers.

Players may bid more than the number of bidding markers supplied. If this happens, you will need to improvise extra bidding markers.

When all players pass consecutively, they each pay for and take the items on which they have the high bid. (The Pass Order cards, marked "First Pass" etc., are not used during the auction.)

If any items remain unsold after all players have passed consecutively, the minimum bid for each unsold item is reduced by £10 to a minimum of zero. The auction then resumes where it left off; from this point on, any player may pass on their turn. This process may be repeated, if necessary. If any item's minimum bid becomes zero, the next player in the auction must bid at least £0 for that item on their next turn. The auction is complete when all items are purchased.

2.2 PLAYER ORDER FOR THE INITIAL STOCK ROUND

After the private railways have been purchased, determine the Player Order for the first Stock Round. The player with the least money will go first; the player with the second smallest amount will go second, and so on. If players are tied, those with more private railways go earlier in the order; otherwise they retain their existing relative order.

During the game, Player Order will be determined anew at the end of each Stock Round.

2.3 EFFECT OF PRIVATE RAILWAYS

Each private railway remains owned by the player who first buys it. Until it is closed by one of the events described below, the owner receives a fixed income, printed on the certificate, at the start of each Operating Round. When a private railway closes, the owner receives an extra payment, equal to the normal income. If it is closed during an Operating Round, the owner receives both the payment at the start of the round and the final payment. It

is possible for a private railway to remain unclosed until the end of the game, in which case its face value is added to its owner's final score.

The owner of a private railway may voluntarily close it at **any time** after the first Stock Round has completed.

Each private railway has a corresponding hex on the map. Unless the private railway has been closed, no company may lay a tile in that hex until the Blue Phase. (The owner may close the private railway in order to allow a tile to be laid.) From the Blue Phase on, any company may build track in the hex regardless, which forces the private railway to close involuntarily. Remove the reminder marker (if used) when a tile is laid in the hex.

Each private railway, except the London & Birmingham (LB), has a special ability that is described on the back of the private railway certificate. The hex where this ability applies is marked on the map (e.g., small hexagon outline, bonus text, or a token symbol), and is usually in a different hex from where the private railway is located. These abilities are described in more detail in [9].

The owner may use a private railway's ability to aid a company they control at **any time** after the private railway closes. (The owner may close the private railway in order to allow the ability to be used.)

The owner of the London & Birmingham (LB) also has priority for starting the LNWR [9].

3. COMPANIES AND SHARES

Each company has one Director's Certificate, which represents two shares, three Preferred Share Certificates, and five Ordinary Share Certificates. At any time, the player who owns the Director's Certificate is the Director of that company and controls all aspects of its operation. If the Director's Certificate of a company is in the Open Market, no player controls it.

The Share Certificates are designed to be stacked on top of one another and fanned either horizontally or vertically. For the benefit of the other players, clearly display all certificates so that they can be easily seen and counted.

3.1 FIVE-SHARE AND TEN-SHARE COMPANIES

At the beginning of the game, companies begin with five shares, represented by the Director's Certificate and three Preferred Share Certificates. A five-share company starts with capital equal to five times its Share Price. Each share yields 20% of the company's income. As the Director's Certificate represents two shares, it yields 40% of the company's income.

A five-share company may convert to a ten-share company during any Stock Round after the one in which it starts [5.4], or during any Operating Round as a result of Emergency Money Raising [6.6.3].

Ten-share company shares yield 10% of the company's income. The Director's Certificate, as two shares, yields 20%. The company receives extra capital and additional station tokens. Until the first 4X train is bought or removed, ten-share companies may own more trains than five-share companies.

From the start of the Brown Phase, all newly-formed companies start as ten-share companies.

3.2 THE STOCK MARKET

When a player buys a Director's Certificate for a new company, they choose the company's initial Share Price by placing one of its tokens in one of the spaces outlined in red on the Stock Market. During the game, the following events will cause Share Prices to change:

- When a player sells shares in a company, its Share Price may drop a number of spaces, depending on a number of factors [5.1].
- When a five-share company converts to a ten-share company, its Share Price will move down two spaces [5.4] or three spaces [6.6.3].
- When a company operates and does not pay a dividend, its Share Price will move down one space.
- When a company operates and pays a dividend, its Share Price will move up a number of spaces, depending on its income, see [6.5.1] for details.

When a company's token is moved into a new space, it is always placed underneath any tokens that are already in that space. If a company's Share Price token is already in the lowest space on the Stock Market when it should move down, it does not move and retains its position relative to any other tokens in that space. If a token reaches one of the two spaces at the top of the Stock Market, the game ends at the end of that Operating Round. If a token is required to move more spaces than remain, it is moved as far as possible.

The lowest four spaces on the Stock Market comprise the light green zone. If a company's Share Price token is in one of the light green spaces, its Director may buy two shares of that company each turn instead of only one [5.2].

Purchase or sale of a share is made at the currently prevailing Share Price for the company concerned, regardless of whether it is a five-share or ten-share company. **Exception:** if a company does not own any trains, sales of shares in that company only return half the current Share Price (rounded down). Purchase of such shares must still be made at full value.

3.3 LIMITS ON SHARE OWNERSHIP

Each player is restricted in the number of Share Certificates that they may own. This limit applies to each player and depends on the number of players in the game. A Director's Certificate counts as one Certificate towards this limit, even though it represents two shares. Unlike some other 18xx games, private railways do not count against this limit.

If a player ever holds more Share Certificates than the Certificate Limit, at the beginning of their turn in a Stock Round they must sell enough Share Certificates in that turn so that they no longer exceed the limit.

A player who already owns 60% or more of a company may not buy a share from the Initial Offering. Shares in the Open Market may be bought even if the player already owns 60% or more.

There is no limit to how many shares of a company may be in the Open Market as a result of players selling shares. Directors' Certificates may be sold to the Open Market [5.3.2].

4. PHASES

Unlike many 18xx games, the phases in 18GB denote colours related to the most advanced train to be purchased or removed. Throughout the game, there are several effects that occur when certain trains are purchased or removed.

The game begins in the Yellow Phase:

- All companies must be started as five-share companies.
- Companies start when 40% of their stock has been sold from the Initial Offering (the Director's Certificate).
- Five-share companies may own up to three trains and ten-share companies may own up to four trains. These limits remain in place until the first 4⁺2 is purchased.
- Companies may not lay tiles in hexes containing open private railways.
- Red hexes and N-S/E-W bonuses are worth the value in the yellow box.

When the first 3⁺1 train is purchased or removed:

- The Green Phase begins. Yellow tiles may be upgraded to green tiles.
- Companies start once 60% of their stock has been sold from the Initial Offering.
- London is worth the value in the green box; other red hexes and N-S/E-W bonuses are still worth the value in the yellow box.

When the first 4⁺2 train is purchased or removed:

- The Blue Phase begins. The two blue tiles may be laid in the blue estuary hexes.
- Companies may lay tiles in hexes containing open private railways.
- Stations are no longer reserved for the GN and MC private railways. Remove the corresponding ability markers from the map.
- Five-share companies may own up to two trains for the remainder of the game.
- Ten-share companies may own up to three trains until the first 4X train is purchased.
- Red hexes and N-S/E-W bonuses are worth the value in the blue box.

When the first 5⁺2 train is purchased or removed:

- The Brown Phase begins. Green tiles may be upgraded to brown tiles.
- All non-started companies become ten-share companies. Add their five Ordinary Share Certificates shares to the stacks of their shares in the Initial Offering.
- London is worth the value in the brown box; other red hexes and N-S/E-W bonuses are still worth the value in the blue box.

When the first 4X train is purchased or removed:

- The 5X trains become available.
- Ten-share companies may own up to two trains for the remainder of the game.

When the first 5X train is purchased or removed:

- The 6X trains become available.

When the first 6X train is purchased or removed:

- The Grey Phase begins. In games with five or six players, brown tiles may be upgraded to grey tiles.
- No more companies may be started. (The Home city station tokens of unstarted companies remain on the map.) Any shares that players may have bought in companies that have not started are returned to the bank, and the players receive half the value of each returned share (rounding halves down).
- Remove one 6X train from the stack of available trains for each unstarted company.
- Only Director sales affect the price.
- Red hexes and N-S/E-W bonuses are worth the value in the grey box.

When two or fewer trains remain available for purchase:

- No more station tokens may be laid.

5. STOCK ROUNDS

In each Stock Round, the players take turns in the order indicated by the Player Order cards. Players continue to take turns in order until they all pass consecutively. This means that if a player takes any action in their turn, they are guaranteed another turn in the current Round.

On a player's turn, they may choose one of the following actions:

- Trade stock by selling one or more shares, subject to the constraints set out below, and/or then buying one Share Certificate from the Initial Offering or Open Market.
- Convert a five-share company to a ten-share company (and optionally buy a share in that company).
- Pass

All transfers of shares are made between a player and the Initial Offering or Open Market. Players may never buy shares directly from one another. Companies never own shares.

5.1 SELLING STOCK

If a player does not convert a company, they may sell as many Share Certificates as they wish, from one or more companies. To sell shares, the player puts the Share Certificates into the Open Market and takes an amount from the bank equal to the current Share Price times the number of shares sold. Exception: if the company does not own any trains, the player takes half the value of each share (rounding halves down).

For example, if a player sells three shares priced at £75, they receive £225, unless the company does not own any trains in which case they receive £111.

Once a player has sold shares of a particular company in a Stock Round, they may not buy shares in that company for the remainder of the current Stock Round.

When a player sells shares in a company, the company's Share Price may drop. These price changes only happen after all sales are complete:

- The price will drop one space on the Stock Market for each share sold. The sale of the Director's Certificate will drop the Share Price by two spaces.
- Until the Grey Phase, all sales of shares will drop the price. After the start of the Grey Phase, the price will only drop when the stock is sold by the Director of the company.

If a player sells shares in more than one company in a single turn, they decide which order to sell them. This will determine the order of companies whose tokens drop to the same space on the Stock Market.

5.2 BUYING STOCK

After selling any shares they wish to, a player may buy a Director's Certificate from the Initial Offering, or one Share Certificate of those available in the Initial Offering or Open Market subject to the constraints listed in [5.2.2].

Exception: If a company's Share Price token is in one of the light green spaces on the Stock Market, a player who starts their turn as the Director of that company may buy two shares of that company in that turn.

To buy a Share Certificate, take the Certificate and pay the current Share Price of the company to the bank.

5.2.1 STARTING A COMPANY

If a player buys a Director's Certificate for a new company, they must first set its initial Share Price by placing one of its tokens on any of the spaces outlined in red on the Stock Market. If the selected space is already occupied, the new token goes below other tokens in the space. They then take the Director's Certificate and pay twice the initial Share Price to the bank.

The amount of stock to be sold from the Initial Offering to start a company depends on the game phase.

- Yellow Phase: 40% (only its Director's Certificate)
- Green Phase and later: 60%

Before the Brown Phase, all companies must be started as five-share companies. For five-share companies, once a company floats, leave its remaining shares available to purchase in the initial offering.

In the Brown Phase, all companies must be started as ten-share companies. For ten-share companies, once 60% of the shares have been sold from the Initial Offering, place the remaining four shares in the Open Market.

In the Grey Phase, companies may no longer be started.

When a company starts, the Director takes the company charter and its station tokens. Each company has one or two station tokens that it will only be able to use when it becomes a ten-share company [5.4]. While the company is a five-share company, it is helpful

to keep these extra station tokens upside down on the charter, as a reminder that they are not allowed to be used yet.

The company receives its initial treasury:

- Five-share companies: five times its current Share Price
- Ten-share companies: ten times its current Share Price.

One of the company's station tokens will already be on the map in the company's Home city. Place the company's other station tokens on its charter in the noted locations. Place a "5/10 Share" company status token with the appropriate side facing up. Place a token to mark the company's revenue on the board as well.

5.2.2 CONSTRAINTS FOR BUYING STOCK

Buy actions are subject to the following constraints:

- In the first Stock Round, a player may only buy certificates from the first tier of the Initial Offering (or from the Open Market).
- The purchase must not cause them to exceed the Certificate Limit.
- If buying a Share Certificate from the Initial Offering, they must not already own 60% or more of that company's shares.
- They cannot buy single Share Certificates in a company until someone has bought the Director's Certificate from the Initial Offering.
- They must not have sold shares in that company in the same Stock Round.
- The owner of the LB private railway has priority for starting the LNWR [9].

5.3 CHANGE OF DIRECTOR

5.3.1 OVERVIEW

If a player, at the end of their turn in a Stock Round, owns more shares in a company than the current Director, they become the new Director. A change of Director may also occur if the current Director sells the Director's Certificate, in which case the player who now owns the most shares (and at least two of them) becomes the new Director. Ties are resolved in Player Order, starting after the previous Director.

The new Director takes the Director's Certificate from the previous Director in exchange for two single Share Certificates. They also take the company charter and all assets thereon.

A player may never buy a share in excess of the Certificate Limit, even if this would make them take the Director's Certificate in exchange for two single Share Certificates.

When a Director's Certificate ends the turn in the Open Market, place a "No Director" card on the company's charter to indicate this status.

5.3.2 SELLING THE DIRECTOR'S CERTIFICATE

A player may sell a Director's Certificate, for the value of two shares, if this leaves them with zero shares or one share in that company. If this causes another player to become the new Director of the company, the Director's Certificate is immediately swapped for shares owned by the new Director and those shares are placed in the Open Market. Otherwise, the Director's Certificate itself is placed in the Open Market.

If a player owns only the Director's Certificate, they may sell a single share of the two that it represents instead of both. If this sale causes a change of Director, they keep one of the two Share Certificates exchanged for the Director's Certificate and put the other in the Open Market. If no other player owns two or more shares and there is a share of the company in the Open Market, they take that share in exchange for the Director's Certificate. If neither case applies, the sale is not permitted.

5.3.3 DIRECTORS' CERTIFICATES IN THE OPEN MARKET

Players may not buy a Director's Certificate from the Open Market. Instead, if a player is the first player to buy a second share in the company, they take the Director's Certificate in exchange for the two Share Certificates they hold. If there are no single Share Certificates left in the Open Market when they come to buy a share, they may buy a notional second share (unless they are at their Certificate Limit) and then exchange their existing Share Certificate for the Director's Certificate. In either case, they take the company charter and all its assets, and remove the "No Director" card.

5.4 CONVERTING TO A TEN-SHARE COMPANY

As their Stock Round turn, the Director of a five-share company may convert it to a ten-share company. A player may not convert a company in the same Stock Round that it starts.

When a company converts, put its five Ordinary Share Certificates into the Open Market, where they are now available for purchase. Any unsold Preferred Shares remain in the Initial Offering. Flip the "5 Share" company status token over to the "10 Share" side on the company's charter.

The company's remaining station tokens become available to be placed on the map during future Operating Rounds.

Move its Share Price down two spaces. Then add five times the new Share Price from the bank to the company's treasury.

When a company converts, the Director immediately has the option of buying a share in the company at the new Share Price, from either the Initial Offering or the Open Market, subject to the usual restrictions on buying shares. If the new stock price is in one of the green spaces on the Stock Market, the Director may buy two shares instead of just one.

130
115
100






In this example, the LYR starts the turn valued at £130. The conversion drops its share price to £100. The LYR receives £500 (five times its new Share Price) in its treasury. The LYR token is placed below the LSWR token that is already in the £100 space. This will change the order in which the companies operate in the next Operating Round.

5.5 PASSING

The first player to pass takes the "First Pass" card. When other players pass, they each take the next Pass Order card. A player who has

passed in one turn of the Stock Round may decide to act in a later turn. In this case, any players with higher Pass Order cards take the card before theirs and the highest pass card in play is returned to the stack, thus preserving the relative order between those players who have passed.

5.6 ENDING THE STOCK ROUND

When all players have passed consecutively, set the new Player Order to match the order in which players passed. Then all players return their Pass Order cards to the stack.

Unlike in some other 18xx games, share prices do not change at the end of the Stock Round, even for fully-sold companies.

Each Stock Round is followed by to Operating Rounds (unless the game finishes after the first Operating Round of a pair).

6. OPERATING ROUNDS

Each Operating Round begins with players receiving income from any private railways that they own. Then each company that has started operates, in descending order of their position on the Stock Market at the beginning of the round. If several companies have tokens on the same space of the Stock Market, they operate in order from top to bottom.

When each company finishes operating, you may wish to flip over its token on the Stock Market, so that players can easily see which companies are still to operate in this round.

Company assets are public knowledge and should be kept visible to all players. A player may not move assets between different companies they control, except for transactions specifically permitted by the rules.

Each company is operated by its Director, if it has one. If its Director's Certificate is in the Open Market, it performs a prescribed set of actions; the players should jointly ensure that these are followed correctly.

6.1 ORDER OF ACTIONS

Each company performs the following steps. Some steps are optional, but if done they must occur in this order. The company's turn ends when the Director states that the company has finished buying trains.

- Optionally lay or upgrade track, and/or place one station token.
- Run trains to establish income.
- Pay dividends or retain income; adjust Share Price accordingly.
- Possibly buy a train or trains.

A company that is Insolvent and/or with no Director may only perform the following steps:

- Run trains to establish income. An Insolvent company may lease a train.
- Retain income; adjust Share Price accordingly.
- If the company has no trains, buy a train.

6.2 ROUTES

Routes are used to determine where a company can lay new track and where it can run its trains. They link stations (large circles in cities), towns (solid black dots), and/or red hexes. A route of a company is a continuous line of track, including somewhere along it at least one station with a station token on it that belongs to the company.

A route may not use any segment of track more than once – this implies it may not cross a given hexside more than once. A route may not even use the small section of track at the junctions on some plain track tiles more than once, which implies that it may not back-track over the sharp angle at such a junction. A route may not reach or pass through any station, town or red hex more than once. A route may end at a station that is completely filled with other companies' station tokens, but may not continue past it. The "GN reserved" and "MC reserved" markers are not station tokens and do not block routes.

Some tiles include two separate stations. A route may include more than one station on such a tile. A station token in one station does not block routes through other stations on that tile.

The green tiles with one station and the green OO stations upgrade to brown tiles with two conjoined stations. On such tiles, a route may not visit the city more than once, and the route is only blocked if both stations are filled with station tokens belonging to other companies. In games with 5 or 6 players, the corresponding grey city tiles are treated the same way.

6.3 BUILDING TRACK AND PLACING TOKENS

Each operating round, a company that has a director and is not Insolvent may optionally perform one or two tile actions, and/or place one station token. Each tile action either places a new tile or upgrades an existing tile in one of the hexes on the map.

If the company performs two actions, at most one of them may be a city tile; one or both must be plain track or a town or estuary. If desired, the two actions may be performed in the same non-city hex (either placing a tile and then upgrading it, or performing two upgrades). For both tile placement and tile upgrade, the new track created must be part of a route of any length for the operating company. In other words, they must be able to trace a line of continuous track from one of the company's existing station tokens to part of the new track on the hex, without passing through any stations that are blocked by other companies' station tokens.

Tiles may not be placed or upgraded so as to cause any track to run off the hex grid. Tiles may not be laid in red or grey hexes. Track may only run into red or grey hexes if it connects to permanent track, but may run into a dark blue hex or previously laid tile without connecting to existing track. For example, track may not be laid in Cardiff (B21) such that it runs into the grey hex B23. Track on a new tile does not have to connect to adjacent track.

Once placed, a tile is considered part of the map and remains there until a company upgrades it to another tile. The supplied quantity of tiles is intended to limit play. If a vital tile is in play, then it must first be upgraded (if possible) in order to free it. This limit does not

apply to yellow plain track and yellow town tiles. The tiles supplied with the game should be sufficient for most cases but the players may improvise additional tiles of these types if required.

6.3.1 PRIVATE RAILWAYS AND TRACK BUILDING

Until the Blue Phase, no company may lay track in a private railway's hex that has not been closed [2.3].

Some private railways have a special ability that gives a company an extra tile action in a specified city [9.1].

6.3.2 LAYING YELLOW TILES

At the beginning of the game, companies may only place yellow tiles. These may be placed in any of the light green hexes on the map. If a map hex is marked with a town or with one or more stations, then the tile must have the same number of towns or stations. Otherwise, plain track must be used. If a hex is labelled 'OO' or 'XX', the tile must have the same label.

If the hex already contains another company's station token, place that station token in a Station on the tile. If the tile contains more than one station, choose a station that is not connected to any track, if possible.

Several companies have a special ability to lay a green tile instead of a yellow tile in their Home city. This is an exception to the usual rule. Such a tile lay counts as a single tile action, not a lay plus an upgrade. This may even be done in the Yellow Phase.

6.3.3 UPGRADING TILES

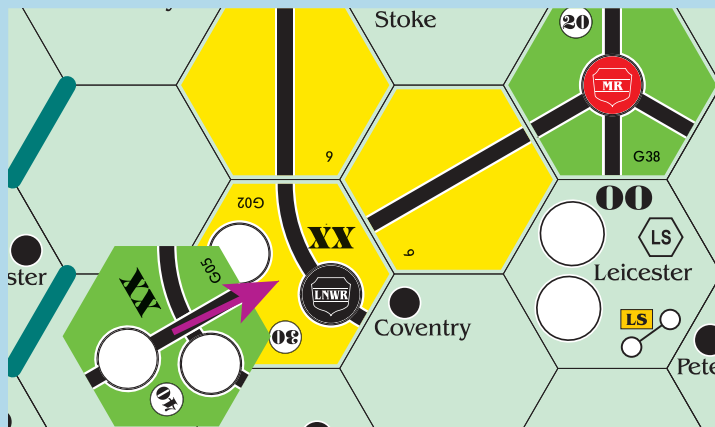
Tiles may be upgraded to green, brown, and (with five or six players) grey tiles from the start of the respective phases. Tiles from earlier phases may still be played as well. Companies must always upgrade tiles progressively: a yellow tile must be upgraded to green, a green to brown, or a brown to grey. After upgrading a tile, the old tile becomes available for reuse.

Plain track, town, and city tiles must be replaced with corresponding tiles; likewise, "OO" and "XX" labels must be preserved. Note that there are two types of brown and grey tiles that have two conjoined stations. Care should be taken to choose the correct tile, as they yield different income. Tiles for double-station cities are labelled "OO" or "XX".

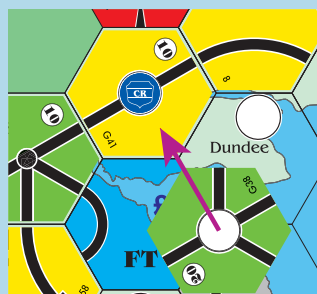
The track on the new tile must maintain all connections between hexsides, and from hexsides to stations, that were present on the old tile. In addition, some part of the track on the new tile which is not on the old must form part of a route for the company. **Unlike most other 18xx games, this additional requirement applies even to city tiles.**

In other words, after placing the new tile and replacing any station tokens that were already in the hex, they must be able to trace a line of continuous track from one of the company's existing station tokens to part of the new track on the hex, without passing through any stations that are blocked by other companies' station tokens.

If the company making the upgrade already has a station token in the hex and this is connected to the new track on the new tile, this condition is trivially satisfied. Take care if the new tile includes stations which are completely filled by other companies' station tokens as these may block the route to the new track.



Example: The LNWR is not allowed to upgrade the yellow XX tile in its Home city because it cannot trace a route that includes new track on the upgraded tile. The MR can upgrade the tile as shown because the new track forms part of a route that includes the MR station token.



Example: The CR station token in Perth is preventing any other company from reaching the new track on the green tile. Therefore, the CR is the only company which can upgrade Perth for the time being. The CR can trivially reach the new track on the tile because it has a station token in the hex.

In the Blue Phase, other companies may upgrade the Forth/Tay Estuary hex, allowing them to trace routes to Perth from other directions. Or, if the CR has already upgraded Perth to a green tile, they may upgrade it to brown because the additional station on the brown tile allows them to trace a route through.

If the old tile had one or more station tokens on it, these are replaced on the new tile in the same stations as they occupied before the upgrade. If a token was in a station that was not connected to any track, it must be replaced in a station that is connected to the new track on the tile.

6.3.4 HILLS AND ESTUARIES

There are two types of difficult terrain on the map. Hills are denoted by thick green-coloured hexsides, while estuaries are denoted by the two dark blue hexes marked “FT” and “S”.

Whenever a company lays or upgrades a tile such that new track on the tile runs into a hill hexside, the company must pay £50 to the bank **for each such hexside**. If the company does not have sufficient funds, it may not place the tile. As completing a connection across a hill hexside will require two such tile placements, the total cost will be £100. These two tiles may be placed by different companies during their respective turns.

The only tiles that may be placed in estuary hexes are the blue tiles with the corresponding “FT” or “S” label. These tiles are available from the start of the Blue phase and may not be laid elsewhere.

They must be placed so they preserve the track shown on the map. Placing an estuary tile is one of the company’s tile actions for the turn and costs the company £50.

6.3.5 PLACE A STATION TOKEN

A company may place a station token, if it has one available, in any vacant station to which it has a route, if it does not already have a station token on that tile. This costs the company £50. (Exception: the CR may place its first station token without charge.)

A company may place its station token before, between or after its tile actions.

A company may only place one station token per turn. Once placed, a station token may not be removed, nor may it be moved to a different station.

Some private railways have the special ability to lay a station token in a named city [9.2], and one station in that hex must be left vacant until that ability is exercised. This requirement lapses when the Blue Phase starts.

6.4 RUN TRAINS

A company that owns one or more trains must now run them and declare the total resulting income. Each of a company’s trains must run on a separate route which must include at least one of the company’s station tokens and at least one other station, town, or red hex. Each end of the route must be a station, town, or red hex. The routes must not share any track segments; however, multiple trains may always run to or through the same stations, red hexes, or towns, provided they do not reuse any track used by other trains of the same company. The routes chosen by a company are not affected or restricted by routes run by other companies.

The income generated by each train is the sum of the values of the stops on its route. The value of a town or station is the number printed on its tile or grey hex. The value of a red hex is the printed number that corresponds to the current phase. For red hexes that list three values, the first number applies in the Yellow and Green phases, the second in the Blue and Brown phases, and the third in the Grey Phase. Multiple trains from the same company can count the income from the same station, town, or red hex, if it is included in the route of each train. If a given train runs through two separate stations on the same tile, only the first generates income for that train.

For 2^{+1} , 3^{+1} , 4^{+2} , and 5^{+2} trains, the large number (before the ‘+’) indicates the maximum number of stations or red hexes (combined) that the train may include on its corresponding route. If the train runs to fewer stations and red hexes than this number, then the route may include towns to make up the difference. The train may also include additional towns up to the number after the ‘+’. The train may not skip any towns or stations on the route.

A 4X, 5X, or 6X train is an express. The number indicates the maximum number of stations or red hexes (combined) that may be included on that train’s corresponding route. The train may run through any number of towns but these do not contribute income. It may not skip stations. An express train also adds to its income £10 times the distance in hexes from the start of its route start to its finish. This distance is measured as the crow flies through the

shortest number of hexes on the map. The route must start and finish at a station or red hex. The distance includes the finish hex but the start hex is not counted.

For example, if the route of an express train starts in London and finishes in Glasgow, the distance is 11 hexes and £110 is added to the train's income. If an express train starts in Plymouth and finishes in Holyhead, then the shortest distance that can be counted through hexes would be 7 hexes and £70 would be added to the train's income.

The company's income is the sum of the income from all its train routes, plus any bonuses that apply. The highest legal income for the company that is announced by any player must be declared. Players need not announce income higher than that declared by the Director. The income track should be used to track past earnings.

6.4.1 BONUSES

If a company runs a train from a red hex marked E to one marked W, or from a red hex marked N to one marked S, add the bonus shown below for the current phase to the company's income. Alternatively, the company may claim this bonus if it has routes run by multiple trains, intersecting at stations or towns, such that part of all of the trains' routes can be combined to form a E-W or N-S route. A company may claim both of these bonuses, or the same bonus more than once, if the routes traced to claim the bonuses do not share any track. (The routes may run through the same town or station.) A single route may not qualify for both N-S and E-W bonuses.

Add bonus for each distinct route connecting N/S or E/W, using all routes run by one or more trains.

Two other bonuses apply if a train uses the dashed track on the map in conjunction with the estuary tiles to connect Bristol (D23) and Cardiff (B21), or Edinburgh (I6) and Dundee (J3) – the amount of each bonus is shown on the tile itself. These bonuses do not count against the number of stops that a train may include on its route. Also, some private railways have the ability to increase the income from a named location.

6.5 DISTRIBUTION OF INCOME

If a company has a non-zero income, it must either pay dividends to its shareholders or withhold its income for itself. (If the company is Insolvent or has no Director, it must withhold its income.) When a five-share company pays dividends, one-fifth of its income is paid from the bank to the holder of each share, with any remainder being lost. When a ten-share company pays dividends, one-tenth of its income is paid from the bank to the holder of each share and the remainder is lost. No payment is made for shares in the Open Market. Shares in the Initial Offering pay dividends to the company.

When a company withholds, its entire income is added to the company's treasury from the bank.

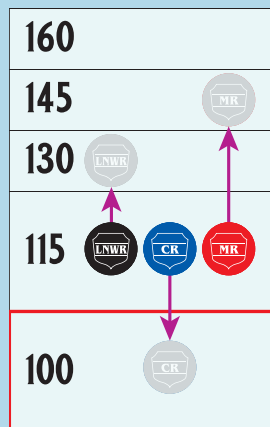
6.5.1 SHARE PRICE ADJUSTMENT

If the company withholds its income, or has no income at all, move its Share Price down one space. If the company declares a non-zero dividend, move its Share Price up at least one space. If its income is equal or greater than twice its current Share Price, move its Share Price up two spaces instead. Similarly, if its income is equal to or greater than three or four times its current Share Price, move its Share Price up the corresponding number of spaces. **The number of spaces moved is based on the company's income, not the dividend paid per share, so a five-share company and a ten-share company are treated the same in this respect.** The Share Price is never increased by more than four spaces.

Example: The LNWR is a five-share company, value £115, with an income of £150 which it pays as dividends. The income received by shareholders is £30/share. The director has three shares, so receives £90. Another player has one share and receives £30. The remaining share is in the Initial Offering, so £30 is paid to the LNWR itself. As the income was more than zero and less than twice the share price, the share price moves up one space.

The MR is a ten-share company, also value £115, with an income of £300 which it pays as dividends. The income received by shareholders is £30/share. The director has five shares so receives £150. Three shares are owned by another player, who receives £90. The remaining two shares are in the Open Market and pay no dividends. As the income was more than twice, but less than three times the share price, the share price increases by two spaces.

The CR is also value £115 and has an income of £300. It withholds its income, so all £300 is paid to the CR itself. Its share price drops one space.



6.6 BUYING TRAINS

If a company has fewer trains than its current Train Limit, then it may purchase one or more trains, either new or from another company. If a company does not own any trains at this point in its turn and does not buy one from another company, then it must buy a new one if it can afford one, except in the specific case described in [6.6.2].

6.6.1 BUYING TRAINS FROM OTHER COMPANIES

To buy a train from another company, the following conditions must be satisfied:

- The Directors of the two Companies agree on a price, which must be between £1 and twice the face value of the train.
- **Either the purchasing company does not own a train, or the selling company owns another train besides the one being purchased.** In other words, a company may not be

left without a train unless the purchasing company owns no other trains.

The purchasing company pays the price to the selling company and takes the train card in exchange. This is the only way that assets may be moved between companies.

A company without a train may buy the only train owned by another company, complying with the conditions above, and then buy a new train immediately after.

6.6.2 BUYING NEW TRAINS

To buy a new train, the company pays the price from its treasury to the bank and the train card is moved to the company charter. If this is the first new train to be bought in this Operating Round, take the Stephenson's Rocket marker from the stack of available trains and place it next to the Game Round track. If the train is the first of a new type to be purchased or removed, this will trigger additional effects [7].

Until the first 4X train, trains must be bought from the bank in order, starting with the 2⁺¹ trains, then the 3⁺¹, 4⁺², and 5⁺² trains, followed by the first 4X train. Each type becomes available after the last train of the previous type is purchased or removed.

After the first 4X train, each type of train becomes available after the first train of the previous type is purchased or removed. Thus there may be several types of train available at the same time. From this point, a company without a train is only forced to buy one if it can afford the most expensive train that is currently available (unless it has no Director [6.6.4]). Although it is forced to buy a train if it can afford the most expensive one, it may buy a cheaper one instead if the Director so wishes.

6.6.3 EMERGENCY MONEY RAISING

If a five-share company does not own a train, does not buy one from another company, and does not have sufficient money to buy the cheapest available new train, its Director may immediately convert it to a ten-share company. This is the only circumstance in which a company may convert in an Operating Round instead of a Stock Round. If this option is taken, follow the usual process described in [5.4], with the one difference that they move the Share Price down three spaces instead of two. This is in addition to the space moved earlier in its turn because the company had no income.

The Director does have the option to buy a share as the last action of the conversion; this is the only circumstance in which a player may buy a share during an operating round.

After the conversion, the company must buy a new train if it can afford one, unless the specific case described in [6.6.2] applies. It may only buy a train from another company in this turn if it first buys a new train.

Conversion is always optional. No other forms of Emergency Money Raising are permitted. Unlike some other 18xx games, Directors may not contribute their own money.

6.6.4 COMPANIES WITH NO DIRECTOR

A company with no Director may not buy trains from other companies. It will only buy a new train if it does not already own a

train, and it is only allowed to buy a single train. If there is more than one type of new train available, it will always buy the most expensive one that it can afford. It must always buy a train if it can afford one, even if a more expensive type of train is also available that it cannot afford. If it is a five-share company and cannot afford the cheapest available train, it will perform emergency money raising and convert to a ten-share company. (As it does not have a Director, the option of buying a share does not apply.)

6.7 INSOLVENCY

A company which ends its turn without a train becomes Insolvent. Place an "Insolvent" card on the company's charter to indicate this. If the Director's Certificate of a company is in the Open Market and the company starts its turn without a train, it is declared Insolvent immediately.

When an Insolvent company comes to run trains during its turn, it will lease a notional train of the cheapest new type available. The company does not own the leased train and the train card is not placed on the company's charter. Leasing a train of a new type does not trigger a phase change. There is no charge for leasing the train.

Insolvent companies may not lay or upgrade track and may not place station tokens. An Insolvent company must retain income; it may not pay dividends. An Insolvent company is subject to the normal rules for buying trains. As it does not own a train, it may be forced to buy a new train when it has sufficient funds (unless it can buy a train from another company first). As soon as an Insolvent company buys a train, it stops being Insolvent and the "Insolvent" card is removed from its charter. If it has sufficient funds and the Director so wishes, it may buy further trains in the same turn, following the normal rules.

As an Insolvent company does not own any trains, any sale of its shares will yield half its Share Price per share sold (rounded down).

Example: The NBR has £600 in its treasury, does have a director, and used to own a 3⁺¹ train until another company bought the first 4X. When the NBR takes its turn, it has no train and produces no income, and so its price drops one space on the Stock Market. The director chooses not to buy a train from another company.

The available trains in the bank include both a 4X and the first 5X. As the NBR can't afford the most expensive available train (the 5X), the director has the choice of whether to buy the cheaper train or to leave it. If they decide not to buy the 4X, the NBR will become Insolvent at the end of its turn. The director does not have the option of Emergency Money Raising, even if the NBR is a five-share company, because Emergency Money Raising can only be used if a company cannot afford the cheapest available train.

The next company to run is the GWR, which is a five-share company with a share price of £90 and with £35 in its treasury. It also owned a 3⁺¹ train and was made trainless when the 4X was purchased. Unlike the NBR, it does not have a director

and therefore becomes Insolvent at the start of its turn. It leases a 4X from the bank, which it runs for £240. It withholds this income, and its price drops one space on the Stock Market.

The GWR still only has £275, which means it cannot afford a train and must use Emergency Money Raising by converting to a ten-share company. (This is compulsory in this situation for companies with no director.) Its share price drops another three spaces, ending on the £65 space. It receives five times the new price from the bank, which gives it a total of £600. As it can now afford a train from the bank, it must buy one; it can't afford the 5X and so it must buy a 4X. As a result of buying a train, the company is no longer Insolvent.

6.8 ENDING THE OPERATING ROUND

The Operating Round ends when all companies that have been started have taken their turn. If no new trains were bought in this Operating Round (noted by the Stephenson's Rocket marker remaining on the stack of available trains), remove the cheapest available new train. If this is the first train of a new type to be purchased or removed, this will trigger additional effects [7]. If no more new trains are available at this point, this triggers the end of the game [8].

Unless one of the conditions for ending the game has been met, place the Stephenson's Rocket marker back on the stack of available trains. Play continues with either the second Operating Round of the pair or the next Stock Round, as appropriate.

7. EFFECTS OF TRAIN PURCHASES

When any company buys the first train of a new type, or the first train of a new type is removed at the end of an Operating Round, this may cause older types of trains to be removed from play [7.1], change the Train Limit [7.2], or trigger the start of a new Phase of the game [4]. The leasing of a train by an Insolvent company does not trigger these effects.

7.1 TRAIN OBSOLESCENCE

When certain types of trains enter the game, older types of trains are immediately removed from the game without compensation.

At the start of the Grey Phase, one 6X train is removed from the stack of available trains for each non-started company.

7.2 TRAIN LIMIT

The Train Limit restricts how many trains may be owned by each company. At the start of the game the Train Limit is three trains for a five-share company, or four trains for a ten-share company. The Train Limit is reduced as the game progresses. If the purchase of a train lowers the Train Limit, companies with too many trains must discard the excess. These trains are removed from the game. If more than one company has excess trains, the Directors decide which to discard in operating order.

A company currently below its Train Limit may purchase a train even if this triggers a change in the Limit which causes the company to be over limit.

A company may buy multiple trains each Operating Round if it has the room and resources, but it must buy each train one at a time. If it purchases the first train of a new type, any adjustments pertinent to that new Phase come into effect immediately. Once any such adjustments are complete, the company may buy additional trains, up to its current Train Limit.

8. ENDING THE GAME

The game finishes at the end of any Operating Round when either:

- At least one company's share price is in either of the two highest value spaces on the Stock Market, which are marked "Game End".
- There are no trains left available for purchase as new trains.

If this happens at the end of the first Operating Round after a Stock Round, the second Operating Round of the notional pair is not played; the game finishes immediately.

8.1 DETERMINING THE WINNER

Each player totals the value of the shares and the face value of any unclosed private railways they own and adds their own money to give their final score. Remember that Director's Certificates are worth two shares. If a company does not own any trains at the end of the game, its shares are each worth half its Share Price (round fractions down). Company money and trains do not contribute to players' scores. The player with the highest score is the winner.

9. PRIVATE RAILWAYS

This section lists the private railways provided with the game, their face value, the income they pay to their owning player each Operating Round (and on closure), and their special abilities.

P1: London & Birmingham (LB)

Cost: £40

Income: £10/OR

The owner of the London & Birmingham (LB) has priority for starting the LNWR. No other player may buy the Director's Certificate of the LNWR, and the owner of the LB may not buy shares in any other company until they have purchased the LNWR Director's Certificate.

The LB hex is the Home city of the LNWR, so the LNWR cannot lay a tile in its Home city until the LB is closed, although it must still place its initial station token there. Usually the owner of the LB will close the LB to allow the LNWR to lay a tile. (If they also own either the GN or the MC, they may use their abilities to start laying track elsewhere instead.)

P2: Arbroath & Forfar (AF)

Cost: £30

Income: £10/OR

The AF allows a company to take an extra tile action to lay or upgrade a tile in Perth (I2) [9.1]. The owner of the AF may use this ability once per game, after the AF has closed, for any company

which they control. A tile placed in Perth as a normal tile action does not close the AF.

P3: Great Northern (GN)

Cost: £70

Income: £25/OR

The GN allows a company to lay the GN station token in York (I14) [9.2]. The GN owner may use this ability once per game, after the GN has closed, for any company which they control.

P4: Stockton and Darlington (SD)

Cost: £35

Income: £12/OR

The SD gives a bonus income of £10 for Middlesbrough (J13). The owner of the SD may use this bonus for any trains run by companies that they control, from the time that the SD closes until the end of the game. Replace the ability reminder marker with the SD bonus token in the Middlesbrough hex as a reminder. This token does not affect tile placement.

P5: Liverpool and Manchester (LM)

Cost: £45

Income: £15/OR

The LM gives a bonus income of £30 for Liverpool (E14). The owner of the LM may use this bonus for any trains run by companies that they control, from the time that the LM closes until the end of the game. Replace the ability reminder marker with the LM bonus token in the Liverpool hex as a reminder of this bonus. This token does not affect tile placement.

P6: Leicester and Swannington (LS)

Cost: £30

Income: £10/OR

The LS allows a company to take an extra tile action to lay or upgrade a tile in Leicester (H21) [9.1]. The owner of the LS may use this ability once per game, after the LS has closed, for any company which they control.

P7: Taff Vale (TV)

Cost: £60

Income: £25/OR

The TV allows a company to waive the cost of laying the Severn Tunnel tile – the blue estuary tile marked “S” – in hex C22. This will be one of the company’s normal tile actions and follows the usual rules for upgrades, so the game must be in an appropriate phase, some part of the new track on the new tile must form part of a route for the company, and the company must not be Insolvent. The owner of the TV may use this ability after the TV has closed, for any company which they control. After using this ability, remove the reminder marker from the hex.

If a company places the Severn Tunnel tile without using the ability of the TV, this does not force the TV to close.

P8: Maryport and Carlisle (MC)

Cost: £50

Income: £20/OR

The MC allows a company to lay the MC station token in Carlisle (H9) [9.2]. The MC owner may use this ability once per game, after the MC has closed, for any company which they control.

P9: Chester & Holyhead (CH)

Cost: £30

Income: £10/OR

The CH gives a bonus income of £20 for Holyhead (C14). The owner of the CH may use this bonus for any trains run by companies that they control, from the time that the CH closes until the end of the game. Replace the ability reminder marker with the CH

bonus token in the Holyhead hex as a reminder. This token does not affect tile placement.

9.1 PRIVATE RAILWAYS AND TILE ACTIONS

The AF and LS may give a company an extra tile action, during its Building Track step, to lay or upgrade a tile in Perth (I2) or Leicester (H21), respectively. It follows the usual rules for placing tiles, so the game must be in an appropriate phase, a suitable tile must be available, some part of the new track on the new tile must form part of a route for the company, and the company must not be Insolvent. After using this ability, remove the reminder marker from the hex, to show that the ability has been used. The use of this ability does not prevent the company from taking one of its normal tile actions in a city as usual.

Note: for the AF, the hex in which the tile action may be taken is not the private railway’s own hex. The AF does not block other companies from placing tiles in Perth, and such tile placements do not close the AF.

9.2 PRIVATE RAILWAYS AND STATION TOKENS

One station in each of York (I14) and Carlisle (H9) is initially reserved for the GN and MC, respectively. The corresponding “GN reserved” or “MC reserved” marker is placed in the city hex at the start of the game to indicate this. These ability markers are not station tokens and do not block any company’s routes. If the MC is not in play, the station in Carlisle is not reserved.

The GN and MC allow a company to place the GN or MC station token in the reserved station space. If the station is on an existing route of that company, this placement is free. If the station is not on a route of the company, the company may still place the extra station token there but must pay £50 to do so. In either case, this station token replaces the “reserved” marker. It counts as the one station token that the company may place in that turn, and may be placed before, between or after the company’s tile actions. Once placed, this token is treated as an additional token of that company for all purposes. An Insolvent company may not place any station tokens and so may not use this ability.

If there is no tile in the hex, the station token may be placed on the empty station (for £50) and the company may then lay a green tile as the first tile in that hex (as one of its two tile actions for the turn), in the same way some companies may lay a green tile instead of a yellow tile in their Home cities. Such a tile lay counts as a single tile action, not a lay and an upgrade. This may even be done in the Yellow Phase.

After placing the station token, put the “GN reserved” or “MC reserved” marker on the charter of the laying company, to show which company owns the token.

When the Blue Phase starts, these stations are no longer reserved and the “reserved” markers should be removed from the map. Any company may place a station token in these cities according to the normal rules. The abilities of the GN and MC may still be used but there is no guarantee that a station will be available. The placement of a station token by another company does not force the GN or MC to close.

10. COMPANIES

Midland (MR)

Red

Derby (H19)

The MR may lay a green tile in its Home city [6.3.2].

London & North Western (LNWR)

Black

Birmingham (F21)

The LNWR's Home city is the LB hex [9].

Lancashire & Yorkshire (LYR)

Purple

Leeds (H15)

As a five-share company, the LYR no station token besides its Home city.

North Eastern (NER)

Light Green

Middlesbrough (J13)

The NER may lay a green tile in its Home city [6.3.2].

North British (NBR)

Orange

Edinburgh (I6)

When becoming a ten-share company, the NBR receives only one new station token.

Caledonian (CR)

Blue

Glasgow (G4)

The CR's first station token is free.

Great Western (GWR)

Green

Bristol (D23)

The GWR has no special abilities.

London & South Western (LSWR)

Yellow

Salisbury (D25)

The LSWR has no special abilities.

Great Eastern (GER)

Light Blue

Ipswich (J25)

The GER may lay a green tile in its Home city [6.3.2].

South Wales (SWR)

Grey

Swansea (A20)

The SWR may lay a green tile in its Home city [6.3.2].

Manchester, Sheffield & Lincolnshire (MSLR)

Brown

Sheffield (H17)

As a five-share company, the MSLR has no station token besides its Home city.

Glasgow & South Western (GSWR)

Pink

Ayr (F5)

The GSWR may lay a green tile in its Home city [6.3.2].

11. VARIANTS

This section lists some optional rules that add some variation to the standard game.

11.1 DISTRIBUTING PRIVATE RAILWAYS

An alternative to the private railway auction is to randomly deal the private railways to the players. Players pay the face value of their private railways. The following procedures are recommended to preserve game balance:

- With two or three players, simply deal out all the certificates.
- With four players, first shuffle and deal the GN, TV, and two other companies selected at random; then deal the remaining four certificates.
- With five players, first shuffle and deal the GN, TV, MC, and two other companies selected at random; then deal the remaining four certificates, skipping the player who was dealt the GN.
- With six players, first shuffle and deal the GN, TV, MC, and three other companies selected at random; then deal the remaining three certificates, skipping the players who were dealt the GN, TV, or MC.

11.2 RANDOM SETUP

As an alternative to the fixed setup, players may wish to experiment by randomly selecting the companies and/or private railways to use at the start of the game. The number selected should match those given in the normal setup for that number of players. This is not recommended for two-player games.

If the LB is used in a game without the LNWR, the rule about priority for buying the LNWR does not apply. The LB, if not closed, still blocks tile lays in its hex until the Blue Phase. If the LNWR is used in a game without the LB, any player may buy the LNWR Director's Certificate.

11.3 SHUFFLE THE LNWR

Instead of immediately placing the LNWR Director's certificate on the Initial Offering at the start of the game, include it with all the other companies when randomly selecting the first tier. Select half (rounded UP) of all the companies for the first tier and put the remainder in the second tier.

If the LNWR is in the first tier, play proceeds as normal. If it is in the second tier, the owner of the London & Birmingham (LB) still has priority for starting the LNWR. If the LB is not closed, no other player may buy the Director's Certificate of the LNWR, and the owner of the LB may not buy shares in any other company in the second tier of the Initial Offering. If the owner of the LB wishes to buy shares in another company on that tier, they must close the LB (thus allowing other players to buy shares in the LNWR). Following the usual rules, the LB prevents any company laying a tile in its hex until the Blue Phase or until it is closed.

12. CREDITS AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

18GB inherits much of its design from other games in the 18xx family, to which 18GB is but a new twist on an established theme.

12.1 PRECEDENTS

1829 (Francis Tresham, 1974) introduced the basic design, including ten-share companies, trains, tiles, station tokens, routes, dividends, the stock market, phases, and private railways.

1830 (Francis Tresham and Bruce Shelley, 1986) added several new features, including the ability to start companies in any order and at different initial prices, the fall in share price when stock is sold, the red off-board areas on the map, and the special powers for private railways when owned by companies.

1835 (Michael Meier-Bachl, 1990) was the first game to use “N+m” style trains.

1841 (Manlio Manzini and Federico Vellani, 1994) first introduced the idea of five-share companies. In 1841, two five-share companies could merge to form a ten-share company.

1825 Unit 1 (Francis Tresham, 1995) was the first published game to make share prices rise a number of spaces depending on the price/earnings ratio.

1826 (David Hecht, 2000) was the first game in which five-share companies could convert to ten-share companies without merging.

1851: Kentucky & Tennessee (Chris Lawson, 1998) The definition of a “route” used in these rules was developed by Steve Thomas, originally for 1851.

18VA (David Hecht, 2001) was the first published 18xx game to use the method for auctioning private railways that I use in 18GB. As I have never played 18VA, I took the feature from experience of playing **18Neb** (Matthew Campbell, 2010). 18Neb was the source of the pass cards for deciding player order at the end of a Stock Round.

1844 (Helmut Ohley, 2003) was the first game to use a mechanic of removing a train from the supply at the end of an operating round. **1880** (Helmut Ohley and Lonny Orgler, 2010) modified this to remove a train only if no company buys one (although the 1880 mechanic removes all trains of a given type).

1860 (Mike Hutton, 2004) refined the treatment of receivership and insolvency compared to 1829 and 1825. It is also the source for the rule limiting the sale of a company’s last train.

I have also taken some phrasing of the rules from **18EU** (David Hecht, 2001) and **1861** (Ian D. Wilson, 2006).

New features in 18GB include:

- The combination of freely choosing which companies to start (as per 1830) with the ability to sell all shares in the company (as per 1825)
- The timing of Conversions and normal Stock Round actions
- The way that track laying interacts with the closure of private railways

- The restriction that companies can only upgrade city tiles if they can run on the new track
- The inclusion of distance when calculating the income of express trains

12.2 PLAYTESTERS

My thanks to the playtesters, who include Michael Berry, Alex Zbyslaw, Jim Knight, Colin Mackenzie, Ian D. Wilson, Steve Thomas, John Hopkins, Lyndon Gurr, Ken Simpson, Mike Hutton, Paul Work, Mike Monical, Chris Shaffer, Mauri Sahlberg, John Boocock, Danny Victor, Bob Lecuyer, Bill Jaffe, Robert G. Schroeder and Martin Brumm.

My thanks to John Tamplin of Deep Thought Games and Scott Petersen of All-Aboard Games for their excellent graphic design and patient editing of these rules into their published form. Thanks to Jason Begy for providing the index.

12.3 A NOTE ON NAMING

18GB is not the first 18xx game to cover the majority of Great Britain. The combination of all three units of **1825** covers a similar area, albeit on a larger board and for a longer game. **1829 Mainline** (Francis Tresham, 2005) is closer in size and scope but has a very different set of rules. **1822** is a recently published game that has a larger map than 18GB and differs considerably in its gameplay.

Given these precedents, my adoption of the “GB” may seem rather presumptuous. One factor in my choice is simply that most of the relevant years have already been taken for other 18xx games. Indeed, I did consider changing the title to 1833, this being the year in which the London and Birmingham Railway was authorised by Parliament, but other games in development that used 1833 in their titles. 18GB seems a simple, memorable name and no insult is intended to the other games.

12.4 MATERIALS AND SOURCES

A good general history of the Railways in Great Britain is Christian Wolmar’s *Fire and Steam*, published by Atlantic in 2007, ISBN 1-84354-630-2.

I consulted several railway maps of Great Britain, some published in the 1920’s and some in modern times. Of these sources, I found J.B.Snell’s *Britain’s Railways Under Steam* particularly useful. It was published by Littlehampton, 1977, ISBN 0-7110-0836-1.

Wikipedia contains several entries for old railway companies, many of which contained useful information for this project.

Image credits:

- Euston station, London, https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Euston_Station_showing_wrought_iron_roof_of_1837.jpg.
- GWR “Iron Duke” 4-2-2 (1847) – Illustrated Encyclopedia of the World’s Steam Passenger Locomotives, Hollingsworth, p28-29.
- LNWR Wolverton Express 0-6-0 (1854) – The Dawn of World Railways, O.S. Nock.

- **NER Class X1 2-2-4T “Aerolite” (1869)** <http://www.docbrown.info/docspics/yorkscenes/yspage09.htm>
- **LYR Class 27 0-6-0 #1300 (1896)** – https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:27_class_1300_at_Buckley_Wells.jpg
- **LSWR Class X2 4-4-0 (1891)** – Illustrated Encyclopedia of the World’s Steam Passenger Locomotives, Hollingsworth, p28-29.
- **MR 4-4-0 Compound #1000 (1902)** – photo of National Railway Museum model.
- **CR 903 Class 4-6-0 #904 “Caldean” (1906)** – Howden’s Locomotives of the World, Hodder & Stoughton, 1910.

er of the George Glyn Character will miss an opportunity to protect the price of a company during a Stock Round).

Two further markers are provided to keep track of when Edmund Beckett’s ability has been used, and one to track George Pullman’s ability each round.

13.3 THE CHARACTERS

C1: George Stephenson - Railway Engineer **Free**

At the end of the first Stock Round, any company that the owner controls may buy a 2⁺ train for £100.

C2: Robert Stephenson - Railway Engineer **£10**

The owner receives £10 for each non-express train bought from the bank by any companies that they control.

C3: Herbert Walker - Railway Executive Committee **Free**

Once per game, at the beginning of any Operating Round after the first Stock Round in the Grey Phase has happened, the owner may nominate one company that they control to make a special contribution to supporting the nation in the First World War. This company may take an extra tile action in either Perth or Salisbury, in addition to its usual two actions (one of which may also be in a city hex). The company may then lease a train from the bank and run this in addition to any trains that it owns. The route of the leased train must include either Inverness or Southampton (or both). Unlike other trains, this extra train may ignore other companies’ station tokens. Its route must be distinct from other trains run by the same company and must include at least one city containing one of the company’s station tokens.

If the nominated company is Insolvent, it may use the extra tile action to place or upgrade a tile in Perth or Salisbury, but may not lay any other track or place a marker. The company leases the next train from the bank twice, to run two routes. One of these routes is run as normal (it may not ignore other companies’ station tokens) and the company must withhold the income from that route. The other route is run as described in the previous paragraph and income from that route may be withheld or paid in dividends.

C4: William Yolland - Chief Inspector of Railways **£10**

Once per game, at the start of an Operating Round, the owner may change the order of operation of one company that they control. To do this, state where in the operating order this company will run. The company’s share price is not affected.

C5: George Hudson - Financier **£10**

Once in each Phase, a company that the owner controls may add up to £50 from its treasury to its income (which must be non-zero), for the purposes of determining the dividends paid and the number of spaces that its price is moved on the Stock Exchange.

C6: Thomas Cook - Travel Agent **£10**

Once in each Phase, the owner may elect to receive a bonus dividend from one company in which they own one or more shares, at the time that the company is paying dividends. The owner receives 1/10 of the company’s income, even if it is a five-share company. This bonus does not affect the income of other shareholders. They may not elect to use this ability with a company that is withholding income.

13. OPTIONAL RULE: CHARACTERS

The optional Character cards add more special abilities to the game, similar in spirit to those of private railways. Unlike private railways, Characters are not linked to particular hexes on the map. The abilities are described on the Character cards and in [13.3] below.

13.1 SETUP AND SELECTION

When setting up the game, randomly select a number of characters equal to the number of players. After the private railways have been distributed and the Player Order has been determined for the first Stock Round, each player may choose one Character or pass. This choice is made in Player Order, so the player with least remaining money will choose first. If a Character has a cost indicated on the card, a player who chooses that Character must pay that cost to the bank.

In games with two or three players, you may optionally deal twice the number of Characters as there are players instead of just one per player. After distributing the private railways, players take it in turns to select their first choice of Character as above (or pass), then repeat the process (in the same order) to select their second Character from those that were not selected the first time.

When all players have had the opportunity to choose a Character, the first Stock Round begins in the same Player Order. If one or more players declined to choose a Character, the leftover Characters are removed from play. The Player Order is not changed after the Characters are selected, even if payment for Characters has changed players’ relative wealth. If the Edmund Beckett Character is in play, his ability may be used at this point.

13.2 TRACKING CHARACTER ABILITIES

Some Characters have abilities that may be used once per Phase (Yellow, Green, Blue, Brown & Grey). Use the cardboard markers with the corresponding character numbers to keep track of when these abilities have been used.

If a Phase ends before the player has used the ability, the chance to use it in that Phase is lost. This applies even if the Phase changed before the player had the chance to use the ability at all (e.g. if a Phase changes twice during a pair of Operating Rounds, the own-

C7: Joseph Locke - Railway Engineer**£10**

Once per game, a company that the owner controls may lay or upgrade an extra tile in its turn. This may be a city tile, even if one of its ordinary tile actions is also to lay or upgrade a city tile.

C8: Isambard Kingdom Brunel - Railway Engineer**Free**

Once per phase, one company that the owner controls may lay a station token free of charge. This placement is subject to the usual rules for placing station tokens in all respects except that the £50 cost is waived. This ability may be used in conjunction with that of the Great Northern or Maryport & Carlisle private railways to place a station token in a reserved space for free even if the company placing the station token does not have an existing route to that space.

C9: Edmund Beckett – Banker/Member of Parliament**Free**

Twice per game, at the start of a Stock Round, the owner may take the first position in the Player Order, regardless of their current position. To do this, take the first Player Order card. The erstwhile first player then takes the second Player Order card, and so on until a player takes the card that the owner began with. Play then proceeds normally.

C10: George Glyn – Banker/Member of Parliament**Free**

Once per Phase, the owner may choose to prevent a sale of shares of a company that they control from affecting the share price of the company. The sale may be made by any player and is conducted as normal in all other respects except that the share price is not altered.

C11: William Arrol - Civil Engineer**Free**

The owner receives £50 every time any company lays an estuary tile. They also receive £50 every time any company lays track that completes a connection across a hill hexside, i.e. track which leads into the hexside and connects to track that leads into the hill from the adjacent hex. If a tile lay completes two or more such connections, they receive £50 for each. Exception: if the ability of the Taff Vale private railway is used to waive the cost to the laying company of the Severn Tunnel tile, they do not receive any income for that tile.

C12: George Pullman - Industrialist**£10**

Each Operating Round, one company that they control may increase the income of an express train by £10 for each station token on its route.

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TILE MANIFEST AND UPGRADE CHART

Tile	#	Legal Upgrades	Tile	#	Legal Upgrades	Tile	#	Legal Upgrades
 G02	3	 G04  G05  G08  G09	 G11	1	 G14	 87	5	 911
 G03	2	 G05  G06  G11	 G21	2	 G30	 88	4	 911
 G18	3	 G21  G22  G27	 G24	1	 G30	 G13	1	No further upgrades
 G19	4	 G21  G24  G25  G26	 G25	1	 G30	 G14	4	No further upgrades
 G39	1	 G36  G37  G38	 G27	1	 G30	 G15	3	No further upgrades
 G40	4	 G36  G37  G38	 G28	2	 G30	 G30	7	 G31
 G41	3	 G36  G37  G38	 G36	4	 G34	 G34	6	 G35
 3	4	 87  88  204	 G37	4	 G34	 40	1	No further upgrades
 4	10	 87  88  204	 G38	4	 G34	 41	1	No further upgrades
 7	5	 18  21  22  26	 16	1	 43	 42	2	No further upgrades
 8	18	 16  17  19  21	 17	1	 43	 43	2	No further upgrades
 9	15	 22  23  24  25	 18	2	 45  46	 44	2	No further upgrades
 58	10	 28  29	 19	1	 44  47	 45	2	No further upgrades
 G04	1	 18  19  20  23	 20	1	 46	 46	2	No further upgrades
 G05	2	 24  26  27	 21	1	 45	 47	2	No further upgrades
 G06	1	 18  19  20  23	 22	5	 41  43  45  47	 911	4	 912
G08	1	24 26 27	23	5	42 43 46 47	G31	2	No further upgrades
G09	1	28 29	24	3	40 45 46	912	2	No further upgrades
G10	2	18 19 20 23	25	2	42 44 45	G32	1	No further upgrades
			26	2	41 44 46	G33	1	No further upgrades
			27	2	43 46	G90	1	No upgrades
			28	2	43 46	G91	1	No upgrades
			29	2	43 45			

Red tiles are only used in a 2-player game, and Grey tiles are only used in 5/6-player games

The supplied quantity of yellow plain and town track tiles is not intended to limit play.

The tiles supplied with the game should be sufficient for most cases but players should improvise additional tiles of these types if required.

Recommended Game Setup

# Players / Scenario	Starting Money	Certificate Limit	Trains in Play							Companies in Play											Private Railways in Play								
			2+1	3+1	4+2	5+2	4X	5X	6X	CR	GER	GSWR	GWR	LNWR	LSWR	LYR	MR	MSLR	NBR	NER	SWR	P1 LB	P2 AF	P3 GN	P4 SD	P5 LM	P6 LS	P7 TV	P8 MC
2P N-S	£375	19	4	3	3	1	2	2	6	●	■	■	■	●	■	●	■	■	●	■	■	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
	E-W £375	19	4	3	3	1	2	2	6	■	●	■	●	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	
3P	£330	14	5	4	4	1	2	2	7	●	■	†	†	●	■	■	†	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	
4P Std	£330	14	7	5	5	2	3	2	7	●	■	■	■	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	
	Alt £330	14	7	5	5	2	3	2	7	●	■	●	■	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	
5P	£320	14	9	6	5	3	3	3	8	●	●	■	■	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	
6P	£305	12	10	7	6	3	3	3	8	●	●	■	■	●	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	

2-Player Tile Restrictions:

- 2P N-S: place the red G90 tile in Salisbury (D25) and the G91 tile in Bristol (D23). Columns A, B and C and out of play. No track may be laid in these hexes and trains may not run to these hexes, including Holyhead and Aberystwyth.
- 2P E-W: place the G90 tile in Carlisle (H9) and the G91 tile in Newcastle (J11). No tile may be laid in the hex between these cities (I10). Newcastle and Carlisle are treated as N endpoints for the N-S bonus.

Other Notes:

- In a 2-player game, a player may only pass in the auction if they have winning bids on two Private Railways.
- In a 3-player game, choose one of the Companies marked †, either at random or by player agreement. GWR will lead to a more open game, while the others to more route contention.
- The alternate 4-player game will be very tight with lots of contention for routes.
- Grey tiles are only used in 5 and 6-player games.

Sample Express Train Distances

London	Aberdeen	15	N-S
	Carlisle	9	
	Edinburgh	11	
	Fort William	13	N-S
	Glasgow	11	
	Holyhead	8	E-W
	Hull	6	
	Inverness	14	N-S
	Liverpool	7	
	Manchester	5	
	Newcastle	9	
	Pembroke	7	E-W
Aberdeen	Plymouth	7	E-W
	Carlisle	6	
	Hull	9	
	Liverpool	10	
	Newcastle	6	
	Pembroke	15	E-W
Holyhead	Preston	9	
	Plymouth	18	E-W
	Hull	7	
	Ipswich	8	E-W
Pembroke	Norwich	10	E-W
	Newcastle	10	
	Norwich	11	E-W
Plymouth	Glasgow	14	
	Hull	10	
	Newcastle	12	

Game Sequence

1. Private Railway Auction [2.1]
2. Assign player order by ascending order of cash on hand [2.2]
3. Stock Round [4]
4. Assign player order by order of passing [4.5]
5. Two Operating Rounds [5]
6. Repeat steps 3-5, until the game ends [7]

Operating Round Sequence

1. Take up to two tile actions (at most one in a city) and/or place a station token, in any order [5.3]
2. Run trains [5.4]
3. Pay full dividends or withhold, adjusting Share Price [5.5]
4. Optionally buy a train [5.6]

Phase Summary Chart

Train Type	Train Limit	Train Price	Remove	Notes
2+1	3/4	£80	—	Start as 5-share with 40% sold
3+1	3/4	£200	—	Start with 60% sold
4+2	2/3	£300	2+1	Private railways no longer block tiles/tokens
5+2	2/3	£500	—	Start as 10-share
4X	2	£550	3+1	5X trains available after first 4X
5X	2	£650	—	6X trains available after first 5X
6X	2	£700	4+2	Remove companies/6Xs, only Director sales adjust, no tokens once two or fewer trains remain unsold